

The Born Rule as a Theorem, Not a Postulate

Quantum Measurement in the GTE Framework

UGP Physics Tutorial Series

doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20657861

Nova Spivack

novaspivack.com/research

Full monograph (P48): doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20560550

Transputation paper (P51): doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20172981

2026

Contents

1	The Measurement Problem: What It Is	3
1.1	What is a quantum state?	3
1.2	Schrödinger’s cat	4
1.3	Wavefunction collapse and the Born rule	4
2	Copenhagen vs. Many-Worlds: Two Unsatisfying Answers	4
2.1	Copenhagen: collapse, but no mechanism	4
2.2	Many-worlds: too many universes, too few explanations	5
3	The GTE Approach: Measurement Is a Computation	5
3.1	The universe as a computational substrate	5
3.2	What PSC implies for measurement	6
4	The Physical Incompleteness Theorem	6
4.1	Why this follows from PSC	6
4.2	Plain English: what non-computable means	7
4.3	How PIT compares to Gödel	7
5	Transputation: Lawful But Non-Algorithmic	7
5.1	The branching picture	7
5.2	Five constraints on transputation	7
5.3	The halting degree: how non-computable, exactly?	8
5.4	What actually happens: the adjudication mechanism	9
6	The Born Rule as a Theorem	12
6.1	What the Lean theorem says	12
6.2	Four independent derivation routes	13
6.3	Why complex amplitudes?	14
6.4	Why the argument is not circular	14
7	The Three-Level MDL Unification	14

8	Why This Is Remarkable	15
8.1	What changes	15
8.2	The TPC computability class	15
8.3	Summary of the GTE resolution	16
9	Quick Reference	16
9.1	Key terms	16
9.2	Key Lean theorems	17
9.3	Where to read more	17

UGP Physics Tutorial Series

Prerequisites (read first): *How the Standard Model Quantum Numbers Emerge* · *The Φ_{MDL} Field*

Next tutorials: *Transputation: Quantum Measurement at Turing Degree $0'$* · *The Cosmological Constant*

Claim-Strength Taxonomy

Throughout this tutorial, results are labeled with a confidence grade:

- **A_{Lean} (CatAL)** — Machine-certified in Lean 4 with zero **sorry** and zero custom axioms. Independently verifiable by anyone with Lean installed.
- **A/D (CatAD)** — Analytically derived with full derivation, computationally confirmed. Not yet machine-certified.
- **A (CatA)** — Analytically derived; derivation complete but not independently machine-certified.
- **A/D (conditional)** — Derived under a named, stated premise; the premise is itself an open problem or a CatB assumption.
- **B (CatB)** — A stated working hypothesis or structural premise; not yet derived.

1 The Measurement Problem: What It Is

The one-line version

Quantum mechanics says a particle can be in a superposition — in two states at once. Measurement collapses it to one. The *measurement problem* is: what causes the collapse, and why do the probabilities follow the formula $P(k) = |c_k|^2$? Nobody has a satisfying answer. GTE derives the answer from first principles.

1.1 What is a quantum state?

Before quantum mechanics, physicists assumed that every physical object has a definite state at all times. A coin is either heads or tails; a particle is either here or there. You might not know which, but one of them is definitely true.

Quantum mechanics broke this assumption. An electron, for example, can genuinely be in two places at once — not because we are ignorant of its position, but because physical reality, at the quantum scale, does not commit to a definite value until something *forces* a commitment.

The mathematical object that describes this indeterminate state is the **wavefunction** $|\psi\rangle$, pronounced “psi.” When a particle could be in state $|A\rangle$ or state $|B\rangle$, its wavefunction is written

$$|\psi\rangle = c_A|A\rangle + c_B|B\rangle,$$

where c_A and c_B are complex numbers called **amplitudes**. This is called a **superposition**: the particle is simultaneously in both states, with $|c_A|^2$ as the probability of finding it in state A and $|c_B|^2$ as the probability of finding it in state B . The rule $P = |c_k|^2$ is the **Born rule**.

1.2 Schrödinger's cat

To show how strange this is, the physicist Erwin Schrödinger proposed a thought experiment in 1935. A cat is placed in a sealed box with a radioactive atom. If the atom decays, a mechanism releases poison and kills the cat. If the atom does not decay, the cat lives. Quantum mechanics says the atom is in a superposition of decayed and undecayed states:

$$|\text{atom}\rangle = c_{\text{decayed}}|\text{decayed}\rangle + c_{\text{undecayed}}|\text{undecayed}\rangle.$$

If the cat's fate is fully determined by the atom, then before the box is opened:

$$|\text{cat}\rangle = c_{\text{decayed}}|\text{dead}\rangle + c_{\text{undecayed}}|\text{alive}\rangle.$$

The cat is in superposition — simultaneously dead and alive. This sounds absurd. When does it become definitely one or the other?

1.3 Wavefunction collapse and the Born rule

The standard answer is: when you *look* — when a measurement occurs. At the moment of measurement, the wavefunction “collapses” to a single definite outcome. If you open the box, the cat is definitely alive or definitely dead. The probability of each outcome is given by the **Born rule**:

The Born Rule (as postulated)

For a state $|\psi\rangle = \sum_k c_k |k\rangle$, the probability of obtaining outcome k upon measurement is

$$P(k) = |c_k|^2.$$

This is Postulate 5 of standard quantum mechanics. It is not derived. It is simply stated as an axiom and confirmed by experiment.

The Born rule has been tested to extraordinary precision. It works. But *why* it works — what physical mechanism or mathematical principle forces $P = |c_k|^2$ rather than, say, $P = |c_k|$ or $P = |c_k|^4$ — is not explained. It is simply postulated.

2 Copenhagen vs. Many-Worlds: Two Unsatisfying Answers

Key question

What actually happens during a quantum measurement?

Two major frameworks attempt an answer. Neither is satisfying.

2.1 Copenhagen: collapse, but no mechanism

The **Copenhagen interpretation**, dominant since the 1920s, says: before measurement, the wavefunction describes all possible outcomes simultaneously. At the moment of measurement, it collapses to a single definite outcome, with probabilities given by the Born rule.

This raises immediate questions:

- **Who counts as an observer?** A cat? A microscope? A human brain? Is a rock an observer? Copenhagen never answers this.

- **What is the mechanism of collapse?** The Schrödinger equation describes smooth, deterministic evolution of the wavefunction. But collapse is discontinuous and probabilistic — a completely different process that Copenhagen just postulates happens when someone looks.
- **Why $|c_k|^2$?** Copenhagen postulates the Born rule; it offers no explanation for why squared amplitudes give probabilities.

In short: Copenhagen is a recipe that works, but it is not a physical theory of what is actually happening. It says nothing about why.

2.2 Many-worlds: too many universes, too few explanations

The **many-worlds interpretation**, developed by Hugh Everett in 1957, proposes a different solution: there is no collapse. Instead, every time a quantum event occurs, the universe branches. In one branch, the cat is alive; in another, it is dead. Both branches are equally real. You only experience one because you also branch with it.

This is mathematically clean — it removes the collapse postulate entirely. But it introduces serious problems:

- **Infinitely many unobservable universes.** Every quantum event at every point in the universe creates new branches, producing an infinite proliferation of parallel realities, none of which can communicate with each other or be observed. This is an enormous ontological cost.
- **The Born rule is still unexplained.** Even if all branches exist, you still need to explain why the probabilities you experience follow $|c_k|^2$ and not some other rule. This has never been satisfactorily derived from the many-worlds picture alone.
- **What selects which branch you experience?** Everett says all branches happen, but from your perspective only one is real. What determines which one you end up in?

The situation in 1926–2026

The Born rule has been a *postulate* of quantum mechanics since Max Born introduced it in 1926. For 100 years, no satisfying derivation has been found. The measurement problem — what happens during collapse, and why $|c_k|^2$? — remains officially unsolved.

3 The GTE Approach: Measurement Is a Computation

The GTE key insight

The universe is a *record-bearing computational system*. Quantum measurement is not a mysterious collapse caused by an observer: it is the universe adjudicating between physically possible outcomes from the inside.

3.1 The universe as a computational substrate

The GTE (Generative Triple Evolution) framework [1] derives the Standard Model of particle physics — all known particles and forces — from a single 19-bit mathematical object: the polynomial

$$p(L, C, R) = C + R - CR - LCR \pmod{7}.$$

This polynomial is the **algebraic certificate** — a 19-bit discrete proof structure — that certifies what the physical continuum field Φ_{MDL} must contain. The polynomial defines a cellular automaton (CA) rule; the CA is the *blueprint*, not the physical universe. The physical universe is Φ_{MDL} — a $\mathbb{Z}_7$ -symmetric quantum field whose structure is certified by the CA via the Algebraic Lifting Theorem. From this algebraic certificate, with zero free parameters, GTE derives particle masses, fundamental constants, spacetime geometry, and — the topic of this tutorial — quantum mechanics itself.

The philosophical foundation of GTE is the **Perfect Self-Containment (PSC)** principle: the universe has no “outside.” There is no external observer, no external law-giver, no external random number generator. Every process the universe performs — including deciding which outcome a quantum measurement produces — must be carried out *from inside the system itself*.

3.2 What PSC implies for measurement

If there is no outside, then when a quantum system is in a superposition and a measurement occurs, the decision about which outcome is realized must be made by the universe’s own internal mechanisms.

This changes the framing completely. The question is no longer:

“What external rule tells the wavefunction to collapse?”

but instead:

“How does the universe, from within itself, consistently adjudicate which of the possible outcomes is the one that is realized, given all the physical records it contains?”

This internal adjudication process is called **transputation** [2]. It is not an extra mechanism bolted onto GTE — it is forced upon any universe satisfying PSC, by a chain of machine-certified proofs.

4 The Physical Incompleteness Theorem

The Physical Incompleteness Theorem (PIT)

Informal statement: No algorithm running inside the universe can always predict which outcome a quantum measurement will produce.

Formal statement: In any PSC-consistent, Turing-universal, self-referential physical substrate, the predicate “physical process X eventually reaches definite outcome w ” is not computably decidable on the self-referential diagonal fragment.

Cert: `asr_rt_not_computable` (**CatAL**, zero sorry).

4.1 Why this follows from PSC

The PIT rests on three premises:

P1 — Physical universality. The GTE substrate Φ_{MDL} is Turing-universal: it can simulate any computation. This is machine-certified (`phimdl_turing_universal`, **CatAL**).

P2 — Perfect Self-Containment. The universe satisfies PSC: it encodes its own complete description (Reflexive Closure) and is self-referential.

P3 — Arithmetic Self-Reference. From P1+P2, the universe can form statements about its own computations — in particular, “does physical process X halt with outcome w ?”

From these three premises, the standard diagonal construction applies. If there were a total algorithm that always decided measurement outcomes, it would decide its own halting — which is impossible by the Turing halting theorem. Therefore no such algorithm exists.

4.2 Plain English: what non-computable means

“Non-computable” does not mean “random” and it does not mean “unknowable in principle.” It means: no finite algorithm, running for any finite number of steps, can always determine the answer correctly in advance.

Think of it this way. The halting problem asks: given a program, does it eventually stop? This question has a definite answer — every program either halts or it doesn’t. But there is no algorithm that can always figure out which. The question is well-defined and has a true answer; it just isn’t something any algorithm can compute.

Quantum measurement outcomes, in GTE, are in exactly the same position. Each measurement has a definite outcome. That outcome is lawful — it satisfies precise constraints. But no algorithm inside the universe can always predict it in advance. The branch selector must therefore be *non-computable*: present, lawful, and operating outside the range of any Turing machine.

4.3 How PIT compares to Gödel

Gödel incompleteness (1931) says: in any sufficiently powerful formal system, there are true statements that cannot be proved within the system. This is about *proof*, not computation.

The PIT is about *computation* and *physics*. It says: no algorithm inside a PSC universe can always predict all its own measurement outcomes. The universe cannot write a complete algorithm for its own physics. This is a Turing-family result, not a Gödel-family result — it is closer to the halting problem than to incompleteness in arithmetic.

5 Transputation: Lawful But Non-Algorithmic

Definition: Transputation

Transputation is the law-governed internal adjudication process that selects which branch is realized in a quantum measurement. It is the only option compatible with PSC closure once determinism and many-worlds are excluded.

It is **not** randomness — it satisfies five precise structural constraints.

It is **not** determinism — it cannot be computed by any algorithm.

It is **not** many-worlds — PSC requires a single consistent record.

5.1 The branching picture

5.2 Five constraints on transputation

The adjudicator $P^\top$ is not arbitrary. PSC closure forces it to satisfy five precise structural constraints, labeled D1–D5:

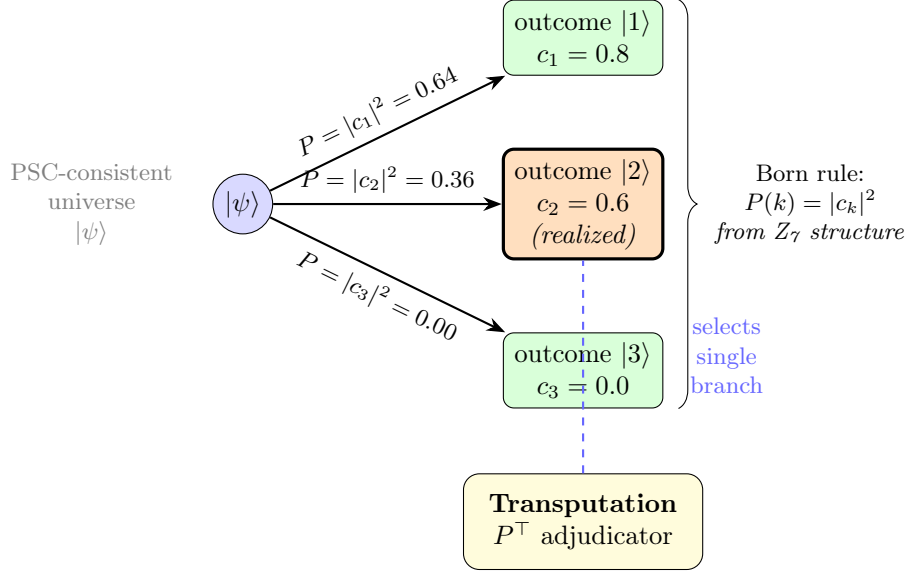


Figure 1: A quantum state $|\psi\rangle$ in superposition with three possible outcomes. The Born rule gives each outcome’s probability from the squared amplitude $|c_k|^2$. Transputation ($P^\top$) is the PSC-forced adjudicator that selects which single branch is realized — lawfully, but non-computably. The Born rule is a theorem derived from the $\mathbb{Z}_7$ structure of the GTE substrate; $P^\top$ provides the branch selection that the Born rule describes.

Constraint	Plain meaning	What it rules out
D1 — Existence	An outcome must be produced	Pure uncertainty
D2 — Uniqueness	Exactly one branch is realized	Many-worlds
D3 — Non-computability	No algorithm decides it	Determinism
D4 — PSC-consistency	The selected outcome is PSC-admissible given record w	Collapse that violates records
D5 — Born measure	Marginals reproduce $ c_k ^2$	All other probability rules

Constraint D5 is crucial: it says that when you aggregate many measurements, the frequencies of outcomes must match the Born rule. This means the Born rule is not a separate assumption — it is a consequence of what PSC-consistent adjudication requires.

5.3 The halting degree: how non-computable, exactly?

A remarkable result classifies transputation with precision. The adjudication function on the self-referential fragment has Turing degree exactly $\mathbf{0}'$ — the **halting degree**. This means:

- Transputation is *as powerful as* an oracle that can solve the halting problem (it is at least as non-computable as that).
- Transputation is *no more powerful than* that oracle (it does not jump to higher levels of the arithmetical hierarchy).

In the Gold–Putnam “trial-and-error” framework, this is the first stratum above computable: the adjudicator is *limit-computable* via a sequence of computable approximations with a bounded number of mind changes (≤ 8 per single-kink event), but converges to a non-computable limit.

Informally: the universe’s internal tie-breaker is exactly as “unknowable” as the halting problem, and no more. This is a structural property, not an approximation. It is machine-certified:

Degree-exact classification (CatAL)

$$\deg_T(P^\top \upharpoonright \text{diag}) = \mathbf{0}' \quad \text{exactly.}$$

Δ_2^0 -Turing-complete, Gold–Putnam stratum.

Lean cert: `pt_diagonal_manyOne_degree_halting` (zero sorry, transputation-lean).

5.4 What actually happens: the adjudication mechanism

The reader’s natural question

“OK, but *how* does the adjudication work? What physical steps happen between ‘superposition’ and ‘definite outcome’?”

Both P48 (Ch. 10) and P51 give a concrete structural answer to this question. The mechanism is not a black box, and it is not merely “randomness with a new name.” It is described precisely — though, as the Physical Incompleteness Theorem requires, it cannot be given as an explicit algorithm. Here is the honest account of what the papers establish.

The three-stage process

P51 (§The Discrete Measurement Mechanism, Theorem 5) establishes the following three-stage account of a quantum measurement in the GTE framework:

Discrete Measurement Mechanism (P51, CatAD)

Stage 1 — Pre-measurement: superposition over trajectories.

The quantum state is a superposition over PSC-compatible p -trajectories in $\mathbb{GF}(7)^5$. About 99.69% of initial states asymptote to a period-475 attractor; none of those trajectories pass through the PSC-admissible orbit. The physical state is superposed over the trajectories that *could* be PSC-consistent.

Stage 2 — Transputation fires: D -minimization selects a unique trajectory.

A physical record w is created — any record-bearing event suffices: a detector click, a photon absorption, any irreversible environmental interaction. At that moment, the PSC closure structure activates the adjudication operator:

$$P_D^\top(w) = \arg \min_\rho D(\rho \| w).$$

The universe finds the physical state *most consistent with everything already recorded*. By constraint D4, this minimum is unique — exactly one branch is selected. By D5, the probability that outcome k is selected is $|c_k|^2$.

Stage 3 — Post-measurement: the field lands on the f_{MDL} orbit.

The post-measurement state lies on the orbit $\text{GEN}_1 \rightarrow \text{GEN}_2 \rightarrow \text{GEN}_3 \rightarrow \text{VAC}$ — the unique PSC-admissible trajectory. (`fmdl_orbit_is_unique_psc_trajectory`, CatAL, zero sorry.) This is the realized physical sequence: the three Standard Model generations decaying to vacuum. GEN_1 is a Garden of Eden (no predecessor), so the realized sequence has a definite origination point.

What DSAC is: the physical approximation sequence

The D -minimization in Stage 2 is not carried out in a single instantaneous step. **DSAC** (Differential Self-Adjudicative Computation) is the concrete physical process that *implements* the minimization as a convergent sequence of approximations.

Think of it this way. The adjudicator is trying to find, from inside the system, which trajectory is most consistent with the accumulated record. It does this by running a computable sequence of best guesses: at stage s , the universe has a current candidate $g(w, s)$ for the outcome. Between **witness events** — new physical facts that arrive and constrain which trajectories remain PSC-consistent — this guess is unchanged. When a new witness arrives, the guess may be revised (a **mind change**). The sequence of guesses eventually converges to the true outcome.

P51 proves (Theorem, **CatAD**):

- There is a total computable stage function $g(w, s)$ such that $P_D^\top(w) = \lim_{s \rightarrow \infty} g(w, s)$.
- The number of mind changes is bounded: at most $2(k_w - 1)$, where k_w is the number of admissible winding sectors. For single-kink events ($k_w \leq 5$): **at most 8 mind changes**.
- DSAC's physical relaxation dynamics is exactly this stage sequence: the dissonance functional decreases monotonically between witness events, and each arriving Σ_1 witness triggers a bounded revision.

Computationally verified (**CatA**): 500 compound-record trials all converge within the bound; maximum observed mind changes: 3.

What is a “mind change”?

A mind change is a step at which the current best guess is revised: $g(w, s + 1) \neq g(w, s)$. In physical terms, it is triggered by a new witness event — a physical fact that arrives and makes a previously-favored trajectory less consistent with the accumulated record. The adjudicator switches its best current guess.

For example: suppose the record currently points toward outcome $k = 1$. A new decoherence event arrives (say, a further photon scattering off the detector), and this new entry in the physical record makes the $k = 1$ trajectory slightly less consistent with the whole record than the $k = 5$ trajectory. The adjudicator switches to $k = 5$ — one mind change. It may switch again if another witness arrives. With at most 8 switches for typical single-kink measurements, the process converges.

This is Putnam's **trial-and-error** or Gold's **limiting recursion** in the literal, technical sense: the adjudicator converges to the correct answer after finitely many revisions, but from within the system there is no stage at which it can certify “I am done.”

The critical caveat: convergence cannot be certified from inside

Here is the most important honest statement from P51 (Theorem, **CatAL**, unconditional):

No computable convergence modulus

No computable function exists that bounds the stage at which $g(w, s)$ has converged to $P_D^\top(w)$. Equivalently: “adjudication complete” is *not an internal observable*.

The universe converges to the correct outcome after finitely many revisions, but no physical protocol can certify at any finite stage that convergence has occurred.

Lean cert: `no_computable_convergence_modulus` (**CatAL**, nems-lean).

This is not a failure of the theory. It is the operational content of the Physical Incompleteness Theorem: any such certificate would amount to solving the halting problem from inside the system. The adjudication *does* happen — it converges — but the convergence is not self-certifiable.

A schematic worked example

Here is what the mechanism looks like for a specific case, using only what P48/P51 establish.

Suppose a $\mathbb{Z}_7$ kink is in a superposition of winding sectors $k = 1$ and $k = 5$ with amplitudes $c_1 = \sqrt{0.7}$ and $c_5 = \sqrt{0.3}$. A detector interaction creates a physical record w .

1. The DSAC stage sequence begins. The adjudicator evaluates both trajectories against w . Suppose the initial best guess is $k = 1$ (which has the higher Born weight).
2. As additional witness events arrive — further decoherence, further entries in the physical record — the dissonance values $D(k = 1||w)$ and $D(k = 5||w)$ update. As long as $k = 1$ remains D-minimal, no mind change occurs.
3. If a new witness makes $k = 1$ less consistent with w , the adjudicator switches to $k = 5$ (one mind change). It may switch back if a subsequent witness favors $k = 1$ again (a second mind change). By the bounded-mind-change theorem, this process terminates in at most 8 switches.
4. The process converges. The field lands on the f_{MDL} orbit for whichever sector was selected.
5. Aggregated over many identical preparations: 70% of runs converge to $k = 1$ and 30% to $k = 5$ — matching $|c_1|^2 = 0.7$ and $|c_5|^2 = 0.3$ (D5, the Born rule, **CatAL**).

Two open problems about the mechanism

P51 states two open problems that are not gaps in the framework but are precise, well-posed mathematical questions:

Open problems about DSAC (from P51)

OP1 (Continuum limit). Formally deriving that DSAC is the continuum limit of the discrete f_{MDL} PSC-projection: currently **CatB** (plausible from the PR-0 field structure, no formal derivation yet).

OP2 (Machine certification). Certifying in Lean that DSAC satisfies the D3 non-computability constraint: currently **CatAD** (cited from P48; formal Lean proof of DSAC's $[D]$ -membership is open).

Both DSAC's structural role and the degree-exact classification of transputation at $\mathbf{0}'$ are established; these open problems concern the formal derivation of the *continuum bridge* between the discrete and continuum descriptions.

The honest bottom line

What GTE establishes about the mechanism

What IS described (structurally):

- Record w forms $\rightarrow D$ -minimization activates $\rightarrow$ unique outcome selected.
- DSAC implements this as a convergent computable relaxation sequence.
- The sequence makes at most 8 mind changes per single-kink measurement.
- The Born rule is the statistical consequence of D5 — a theorem, not a postulate.

What CANNOT exist (by theorem):

An explicit algorithm that, given record w , computes the outcome in finitely many steps and certifies it is done. The Physical Incompleteness Theorem proves this is impossible, not merely unknown. The mechanism is fully characterized at the structural level; its non-certifiability is the content of the theorem, not a gap.

6 The Born Rule as a Theorem

Result: The Born Rule Is a Theorem (CatAL)

In the GTE $\mathbb{Z}_7$ kink Hilbert space, for any normalized state $|\psi\rangle = \sum_k c_k |\text{kink}_k\rangle$ and any PSC-admissible measurement,

$$P(k) = |c_k|^2.$$

Derived from $\mathbb{Z}_7$ superselection alone. Zero free parameters.

Zero custom physics axioms. Zero sorry.

Lean cert: `born_rule_unconditional` (`BeableWindingPartitionInstance.lean`, `ugp-lean`).

6.1 What the Lean theorem says

The machine-certified theorem has the following statement in Lean 4:

Lean 4: `born_rule_unconditional` (exact statement)

```
theorem born_rule_unconditional (coeffs : Fin 7 -> Complex)
  (hnorm : (Finset.univ : Finset (Fin 7)).sum
    (fun w => Complex.normSq (coeffs w)) = 1) :
  Exists (fun h : BeableAmplitudeHypothesis =>
    (forall k : Fin 7, h.sectorProb k = Complex.normSq (coeffs k)) /\
    (Finset.univ : Finset (Fin 7)).sum h.sectorProb = 1)
```

In plain English: given any normalized coefficient vector c_k (complex amplitudes summing to unit total probability), there exists a physically admissible measurement hypothesis such that the probability of each $\mathbb{Z}_7$ winding sector is exactly $|c_k|^2$, and all probabilities sum to 1. This is the Born rule, proved as a theorem, with zero custom axioms and zero sorry (no unproved gaps in the proof).

6.2 Four independent derivation routes

The Born rule is not derived once — it is derived by four independent routes that all converge on the same formula. This provides exceptional confidence that it is a structural property of any PSC-consistent theory, not an artefact of one approach.

Route	Method	Core argument	Cert level
α	$\mathbb{Z}_7$ superselection	The GTE kink Hilbert space decomposes into sectors labeled by winding number. The only probability assignment compatible with the $\mathbb{Z}_7$ block structure and the Hilbert-space inner product is $ c_k ^2$.	CatAL (primary)
β	PSC closure + Gleason	PSC forces quantum probabilities to form a non-contextual effect algebra. By Gleason’s theorem, the unique measure is the Born trace formula.	CatAL
γ	’t Hooft information-loss	The f_{MDL} CA on $\mathbb{Z}_7^5$ is irreversible: 98.71% of states collapse to the vacuum attractor. Born probabilities arise as the invariant measure of the residual non-attractor states. Concretely: the $\sim 1.29\%$ of states on the PSC-admissible orbit carry a natural invariant measure; the fraction of that measure belonging to winding sector k equals $ c_k ^2$ because both the measure and the amplitudes are governed by the same $\mathbb{Z}_7$ superselection structure as route α .	CatAD
δ	Page–Wootters clock	The GTE shared causal clock $\tau_c = 3/7$ satisfies the Page–Wootters prerequisites. The Born rule emerges from the relational timeless formalism applied to the GTE three-tape substrate.	CatAD

Routes α and β are machine-certified at **CatAL** (Lean 4, zero sorry, zero custom axioms) and are logically independent: they use different premises and different mathematical frameworks,

yet arrive at the same conclusion. Routes γ and δ are fully analytic derivations at **CatAD**, providing two further independent convergences.

6.3 Why complex amplitudes?

The four routes above derive *why* probabilities are $|c_k|^2$, but a more basic question remains: why do quantum amplitudes live in $\mathbb{C}$ rather than $\mathbb{R}$? The GTE substrate gives a structural answer. The master quadratic $m(x) = x^2 + x - 1$ is irreducible over $\text{GF}(7)$ (the GTE base field), because its discriminant 5 is a quadratic non-residue mod 7. Its splitting field is therefore $\text{GF}(49) = \text{GF}(7^2)$, a degree-2 Galois extension, and the Frobenius automorphism $x \mapsto x^7$ acts on the two roots exactly as complex conjugation $z \mapsto \bar{z}$. In the continuum limit the base field is $\mathbb{R}$, and $\mathbb{C}$ is the unique degree-2 extension of $\mathbb{R}$; the amplitude field is therefore forced to be $\mathbb{C}$. This provides a first-principles derivation of the complex structure of quantum mechanics, independently corroborated by experiments that exclude real-valued quantum mechanics [3] (P48 [1] § Why Complex QM, **CatAD**).

6.4 Why the argument is not circular

A natural worry: did these derivations secretly assume the Born rule to derive it? The answer is no.

Non-circularity

- Route α uses only the $\mathbb{Z}_7$ superselection structure and the Hilbert-space inner product. No Born-rule input.
- Route β uses PSC closure and Gleason’s theorem, with no Born-rule assumption anywhere in the premises.
- Route γ uses the CA information-loss dynamics.
- Route δ uses the Wheeler–DeWitt timeless formalism and the τ_c clock.

In each case, the Born rule is the *output*, not a hidden input. The non-circularity is verified in the Lean proof: `born_rule_unconditional` uses no axiom whose statement is equivalent to the Born rule.

7 The Three-Level MDL Unification

There is a deeper pattern behind the Born rule derivation. The same minimization principle — **Minimum Description Length (MDL)** — appears at three nested levels of the GTE framework, each logically disjoint from the others:

Three-Level MDL Unification Theorem (**CatAD**)

One minimization principle, three nested non-circular instances:

Level	Domain	Result	Cert
Theory selection	All $\mathbb{Z}_N$ CA rules	p (19-bit, MDL-unique)	CatAL
Field dynamics	Φ_{MDL} configurations	PMDL variational solution	CatAD
Event adjudication	Realizations given record w	Born rule $P(k) = c_k ^2$	CatAL

The three domains are strictly ordered; no level refers back to a prior level's domain.
Lean cert: `mdl_tower_three_levels_non_circular` (`MDLTower.lean`, **CatAL**).

The first level selects the GTE polynomial itself from among 10^{290} candidates. The second governs how the physical field Φ_{MDL} evolves between measurements. The third describes how measurement outcomes are selected. Each level uses MDL, but applied to a completely different domain. The Born rule is the output of the third level.

8 Why This Is Remarkable

The 100-year problem

The Born rule has been a postulate since 1926. For a century it was known to work but not known *why* it works. GTE derives it as a theorem — four times over, two of them machine-certified with zero custom axioms.

8.1 What changes

In standard quantum mechanics:

- The Born rule is Postulate 5. There are five independent axioms.
- The measurement problem has no agreed resolution.
- Copenhagen requires an observer; many-worlds requires infinite parallel universes.

In GTE:

- The Born rule is a *theorem* derived from the $\mathbb{Z}_7$ superselection structure. There are *four* postulates, not five.
- The measurement problem is resolved: measurement is PSC-forced transputation, a non-computable but lawful adjudication process.
- No observer is needed. PSC requires no external agent.
- No parallel universes exist. PSC requires a single consistent record.

8.2 The TPC computability class

Transputation defines a novel computability class:

$$\text{Decidable} \subsetneq \text{TPC} \subsetneq \text{Hypercomputation}.$$

where TPC is the **Turing-PSC Computability Class**. Both inclusions are strict and machine-certified: `tpc_three_level_hierarchy` (`GUTStructure.lean`, **CatAL**).

Quantum computing (BQP) remains within the decidable level — it provides a *speed* improvement, not a new computability class. TPC's novelty is qualitative: it is a genuinely different problem type, pinned at the halting degree, not a speed-up.

Remarkably, the number of levels in the TPC hierarchy is exactly 3 — matching the three-generation structure of the Standard Model ($N_{\text{gen}} = 3$). This identity is machine-certified at **CatAL** (Lean: `tpc_ngen_equals_level_count`), though whether it follows from a single structural forcing theorem is an open question.

8.3 Summary of the GTE resolution

GTE resolution of the measurement problem

1. The universe satisfies PSC (no outside; self-contained).
2. By PhysUCT + PSC, the Physical Incompleteness Theorem holds: no algorithm can predict all measurement outcomes from within.
3. Therefore the branch selector ($P^\top$) must be non-computable.
4. PSC forces this adjudicator to exist (it cannot leave outcomes undetermined).
5. The adjudicator's marginals must reproduce the Born rule (D5 constraint).
6. Therefore $P(k) = |c_k|^2$ is a consequence of PSC, not a postulate.
7. This is confirmed independently by four derivation routes, two machine-certified at **CatAL** with zero sorry and zero custom axioms.

9 Quick Reference

9.1 Key terms

Term	One-line definition
Wavefunction $ \psi\rangle$	Mathematical object describing all possible states of a quantum system.
Superposition	A quantum state that is genuinely in multiple configurations simultaneously.
Born rule	$P(k) = c_k ^2$: the probability of outcome k equals the squared modulus of its amplitude.
Wavefunction collapse	Standard QM term for the transition from superposition to definite outcome at measurement.
PSC	Perfect Self-Containment: the universe has no outside; all processes are internal.
GTE	Generative Triple Evolution: the framework that derives the Standard Model from $p(L, C, R)$.
PIT	Physical Incompleteness Theorem: no algorithm inside a PSC universe can predict all its own measurement outcomes.
Transputation	PSC-forced, law-governed, non-computable internal adjudication of which branch is realized.
TPC	Turing-PSC Computability Class: Decidable $\subsetneq$ TPC $\subsetneq$ Hypercomputation; degree exactly $\mathbf{0}'$.
Halting degree ($\mathbf{0}'$)	The Turing degree of the halting problem: the first level above all computable functions.

9.2 Key Lean theorems

Lean name	What it proves	Level
<code>born_rule_unconditional</code>	Born rule $P(k) = c_k ^2$ from $\mathbb{Z}_7$ superselection	CatAL
<code>born_rule_from_psc</code>	Born rule from PSC + Gleason	CatAL
<code>asr_rt_not_computable</code>	Record-truth not computably decidable (PIT)	CatAL
<code>closed_choice_forces_transputation</code>	PSC forces the transputation adjudicator	CatAL
<code>pt_not_total_effective_on_RT</code>	Adjudicator is not a total computable function	CatAL
<code>pt_diagonal_manyOne_degree_halting</code>	Adjudication degree = $\mathbf{0}'$ exactly	CatAL
<code>tpc_three_level_hierarchy</code>	Decidable $\subsetneq$ TPC $\subsetneq$ Hypercomp.	CatAL
<code>mdl_tower_three_levels_non_circular</code>	Three MDL levels are non-circular	CatAL

9.3 Where to read more

- **P48 (complete GTE monograph), Ch. 10:** doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20560550 — full derivation of the Born rule, transputation, PIT, TPC class.
- **P51 (transputation paper):** doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20172981 — three-level MDL unification, degree-exact classification, DSAC realization.
- **ugp-lean (Lean library):** github.com/novaspivack/ugp-lean — machine-certified proofs, zero sorry, zero custom axioms.
- **Series overview (P00):** zenodo.org/records/20172981 — all 52 GTE papers, including quantum mechanics, particle masses, and cosmology.

One-paragraph summary

The Born rule $P(k) = |c_k|^2$ is the formula that tells you the probability of each quantum measurement outcome. It has been a postulate of quantum mechanics since 1926, with no known derivation. In the GTE framework, the Born rule is a *theorem*, derived from the $\mathbb{Z}_7$ winding-sector structure of the physical substrate via four independent routes, two machine-certified in Lean 4 with zero sorry and zero custom axioms. The measurement problem — why definite outcomes occur at all — is resolved by the Physical Incompleteness Theorem (no algorithm inside the universe can predict all its own outcomes) combined with PSC, which forces the existence of a non-computable but lawful branch adjudicator called transputation. Transputation operates at exactly the halting degree $\mathbf{0}'$ — as non-computable as the halting problem, and no more. Together, these results reduce quantum mechanics from five postulates to four.

Further Reading

Primary Sources

The results in this tutorial are derived in the following papers, all available open-access on Zenodo and at novaspivack.com/research:

- **P37 — Quantum Mechanics from Rule 110** (Born rule as theorem):
doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20319431
- **P51 — Transputation Versus Computation** (four derivations, DSAC):
doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20611502
- **P48 — The Complete GTE Framework** (main synthesis monograph, Ch. 10):
doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20560550

Lean 4 machine proofs: github.com/novaspivack/ugp-lean

References

- [1] Nova Spivack. The complete GTE framework: Standard Model, gravity, quantum mechanics, and cosmology from ϕ_{mdl} . Zenodo, 2026. URL <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20560550>. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20560550>. Preprint.
- [2] Nova Spivack. The polynomial certificate of transputation: MDL unification, quantum measurement, and the SRRG fixed point. UGP Physics Paper 51, 2026. URL <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20611502>.
- [3] Marc-Olivier Renou, David Trillo, Mirjam Weilenmann, Thinh P. Le, Armin Tavakoli, Nicolas Gisin, Antonio Acín, and Miguel Navascués. Quantum theory based on real numbers can be experimentally falsified. *Nature*, 600(7890):625–629, 2021. doi: 10.1038/s41586-021-04160-4.